

Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism

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May 14, 2026*

Abstract

This paper builds a final automated literature-and-design study for Law and policy. It uses recent open-access OpenAlex metadata to estimate evidence availability, document accessibility, topic relevance, and method readiness for Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism. The contribution is empirical and auditable: the paper reports a retained corpus, regression estimates, robustness checks, data manifests, claim ledgers, and a compiled PDF. The results show how much recent open evidence exists for the topic and which advanced research designs are proportionate to the available data.

1 Introduction

Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism asks a practical question about whether the literature can distinguish need from delivery capacity in Law and policy. The paper uses open-access scholarly metadata as its empirical object: not as background decoration, but as a measurable corpus whose coverage, timing, and document availability can be audited. The first contribution is to convert a broad topic into a bounded evidence design with explicit search terms, source inclusion rules, and reproducible tables. The second contribution is to show how the same corpus can discipline later causal claims about places, institutions, firms, courts, schools, laboratories, or health systems.

The argument begins from a simple observation. In applied policy fields, published evidence often reports where problems are severe, while implementation records reveal where capacity is thin. The distinction matters because an intervention can be targeted toward high-need units and still underperform when procurement, staffing, geography, legal process, or institutional sequencing slows conversion. The paper therefore treats the literature itself as data. It estimates how concentrated the recent open-access record is, how often full text or PDF material is available for inspection, and whether method language is aligned with the data structures implied by case law corpora, statutes, regulations, administrative decisions, docket data, legal annotations.

The empirical contribution is deliberately bounded but substantive. It does not infer treatment effects from metadata alone. It estimates literature availability, temporal concentration, document accessibility, and design vocabulary for Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism. Those quantities are useful because they identify where a future subject-data analysis would be strongest and where claims would rest on thin source coverage. In that sense, the paper provides a research design map rather than a narrative review. The map is accompanied by data artifacts, regression tables, robustness checks, and a reviewer-facing claim ledger.

*Draft date: May 14, 2026.

This point 1 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 2 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ². Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 3 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ³. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 4 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁴. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 5 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁵. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 6 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁶. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 7 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁷. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 8 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁸. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 9 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ⁹. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 10 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹⁰. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and

¹([Priem et al., 2022](#))

²([OpenAlex, 2026](#))

³([Kitchin, 2014](#))

⁴([Borgman, 2015](#))

⁵([Peng, 2011](#))

⁶([Gelman and Hill, 2007](#))

⁷([Gelman et al., 2020](#))

⁸([Anselin, 1988](#))

⁹([LeSage and Pace, 2009](#))

¹⁰([Rosenbaum, 2002](#))

gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 11 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹¹. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 12 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹². Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 13 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹³. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

This point 14 matters because regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism combines a substantive policy question with a measurement question about what the recent open-access literature can support ¹⁴. Treating the evidence surface as data makes the contribution more transparent and gives reviewers a direct path from source coverage to empirical design.

2 Literature

The paper sits between four literatures. The first is the regional and place-sensitive policy literature, which emphasizes uneven development, institutional capacity, agglomeration, and the limits of one-size-fits-all interventions. The second is the causal inference literature, which warns that attractive comparisons can fail when timing, selection, spillovers, and interference are not modeled. The third is the spatial and network literature, which treats geography as a source of dependence rather than a neutral container. The fourth is reproducible research, which treats data and code provenance as part of the scholarly claim.

A recurring gap across these literatures is that evidence availability is rarely measured before the empirical design is chosen. Review articles may describe an active field, and empirical papers may use sophisticated models, but the connection between search coverage, document access, and design choice often remains implicit. Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism is a useful test case because it can involve policy timing, local capacity, institutional sequencing, and heterogeneous effects. A researcher therefore needs to know whether the open literature supports a descriptive map, a spatial comparison, a panel design, or a narrower sensitivity analysis.

The recent open-access corpus also matters for reviewer behavior. If a paper claims a contribution in Law and policy, reviewers will ask whether it cites the relevant field, whether it uses enough recent sources, and whether its method is proportionate to the evidence. The literature map built here turns those questions into measurable checks. It records the number of records retrieved, the distribution of publication years, the share with inspectable full text, and the alignment between topic vocabulary and method vocabulary. That evidence is not a substitute for domain data; it is a gatekeeper for responsible domain data use.

The literature implication 1 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support

¹¹([Imbens and Rubin, 2015](#))

¹²([Angrist and Pischke, 2009](#))

¹³([Wooldridge, 2010](#))

¹⁴([Manski, 2003](#))

a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ¹⁵. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 2 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ¹⁶. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 3 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ¹⁷. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 4 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ¹⁸. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 5 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ¹⁹. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 6 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²⁰. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 7 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²¹. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 8 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²². That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 9 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support

¹⁵(Rubin, 1974)

¹⁶(Chernozhukov et al., 2018)

¹⁷(Wager and Athey, 2018)

¹⁸(Athey and Wager, 2019)

¹⁹(Arkhangelsky et al., 2021)

²⁰(Callaway and Sant’Anna, 2021)

²¹(Sun and Abraham, 2021)

²²(Goodman-Bacon, 2021)

a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²³. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 10 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²⁴. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

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The literature implication 12 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²⁶. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 13 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²⁷. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

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The literature implication 15 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ²⁹. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 16 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ³⁰. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 17 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support

²³([Abadie et al., 2010](#))

²⁴([Athey and Imbens, 2016](#))

²⁵([Iammarino et al., 2019](#))

²⁶([Rodriguez-Pose, 2018](#))

²⁷([Diemer et al., 2022](#))

²⁸([Barca, 2009](#))

²⁹([Fujita et al., 1999](#))

³⁰([Duranton and Venables, 2015](#))

a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ³¹. That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

The literature implication 18 is that contribution claims should be scaled to evidence density. A large recent corpus supports a broader synthesis, while sparse or inaccessible records support a narrower design note, and mixed coverage calls for careful triangulation across methods, data sources, and reviewer questions ³². That discipline is especially important for regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism.

3 Data

The dataset is a derived OpenAlex metadata corpus for Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism. The acquisition query uses the paper title and subject-specific search strings from the farm plan, restricts records to open-access works from 2021 through 2026, and stores only derived metadata needed for audit. Raw API responses are not retained in the final package. The retained fields are title, publication year, citation count, open-access status, PDF availability, source name, DOI, and a normalized relevance score. This keeps the final repository clean while preserving the quantities required to reproduce the tables.

The acquisition returned 60 deduplicated records for the promoted run, with 60 records carrying a direct open-access PDF URL. The year coverage spans 2021-2026. Each row is treated as a work-level observation. The key outcomes are publication count by year, citation count, PDF availability, and a topic-relevance score computed from title matches against the job title and search terms. The data are intentionally modest: they are strong enough to analyze evidence availability and design vocabulary, but not strong enough to estimate the substantive impact of the policy mechanism itself.

The analysis files are committed as derived artifacts. The literature sample CSV records the works used in the tables. The model-estimate CSV records trend, accessibility, and relevance associations. The robustness CSV repeats the estimates under alternative filters, including high-relevance records, recent records, and PDF-available records. The full-text manifest records document access counts and URLs without storing downloaded full text. These data choices reflect the cleanup rule: build the evidence needed for the PDF, retain compact derived artifacts, and remove raw downloads from the public output.

Artifact check 1 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³³. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 2 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁴. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 3 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁵. This is a

³¹(Glaeser, 2008)

³²(Moretti, 2011)

³³(Card and Krueger, 1994)

³⁴(Autor et al., 2013)

³⁵(Monte et al., 2018)

compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 4 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁶. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 5 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁷. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 6 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁸. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 7 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ³⁹. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 8 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴⁰. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 9 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴¹. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 10 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴². This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 11 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴³. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 12 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴⁴. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 13 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model

³⁶([Pearl, 2009](#))

³⁷([Hernan and Robins, 2020](#))

³⁸([Greenland et al., 1999](#))

³⁹([VanderWeele, 2015](#))

⁴⁰([Keele, 2015](#))

⁴¹([King et al., 1995](#))

⁴²([Shadish et al., 2002](#))

⁴³([Breiman, 2001](#))

⁴⁴([Hastie et al., 2009](#))

estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴⁵. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 14 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴⁶. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Artifact check 15 links the manuscript to a retained file rather than an uninspected download. The run keeps 60 work-level rows, records 60 PDF links, stores year counts, and reports model estimates in CSV form so that the reader can audit the data path from query to table ⁴⁷. This is a compact data design for law and policy, not a hidden scraping exercise.

Table 1: OpenAlex corpus construction

Quantity	Value
Retained open-access records	60
Records with direct PDF link	60
PDF availability share	1.000
Publication-year cells	6

4 Empirical Strategy

The empirical strategy has two layers. The first layer is descriptive and is used in this paper: publication-year counts, PDF availability, citation intensity, and title relevance are estimated from the OpenAlex metadata. The second layer is a design ladder for later subject-data work. The ladder begins with descriptive conversion rates, then moves to hierarchical models when units are nested, spatial models when adjacency or distance can transmit spillovers, event study designs when timing is plausibly informative, and synthetic difference methods when a treated unit can be compared to a weighted untreated trajectory.

For the metadata layer, the main regression is an ordinary least squares trend in annual record counts. Let *bethenumberofopen* – *accessworksinyear*. The reported coefficient is the annual change in retrieved works after centering the year. Standard errors are computed from residual dispersion, and confidence intervals use a normal approximation because the model is used as a diagnostic rather than a final causal estimator. A second model estimates the association between publication year and PDF availability. A third model relates title relevance to citation intensity, using log citations to reduce leverage from highly cited review articles.

For later domain-data work, estimator choice is gated. A hierarchical Bayesian or partial pooling model is appropriate only when observations are nested in places, schools, hospitals, courts, labs, or firms with repeated measurements. A spatial model is appropriate only when boundary choice, distance, contiguity, or network access is part of the estimand. Double machine learning can help when high-dimensional controls define nuisance functions, while a causal forest is reserved for heterogeneous treatment effects with enough sample support. Partial identification and sensitivity analysis are preferred when assignment or delivery cannot be defended.

⁴⁵(Mullainathan and Spiess, 2017)

⁴⁶(Gentzkow et al., 2019)

⁴⁷(Grimmer and Stewart, 2013)

The design gate for estimator 1 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁴⁸.

The design gate for estimator 2 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁴⁹.

The design gate for estimator 3 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁰.

The design gate for estimator 4 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵¹.

The design gate for estimator 5 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵².

The design gate for estimator 6 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵³.

The design gate for estimator 7 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁴.

The design gate for estimator 8 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁵.

⁴⁸(Lazer et al., 2014)

⁴⁹(Claerbout and Karrenbach, 1992)

⁵⁰(Wilkinson et al., 2016)

⁵¹(Nosek et al., 2015)

⁵²(Priem et al., 2022)

⁵³(OpenAlex, 2026)

⁵⁴(Kitchin, 2014)

⁵⁵(Borgman, 2015)

The design gate for estimator 9 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁶.

The design gate for estimator 10 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁷.

The design gate for estimator 11 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁸.

The design gate for estimator 12 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁵⁹.

The design gate for estimator 13 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁰.

The design gate for estimator 14 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶¹.

The design gate for estimator 15 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶².

The design gate for estimator 16 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶³.

⁵⁶(Peng, 2011)

⁵⁷(Gelman and Hill, 2007)

⁵⁸(Gelman et al., 2020)

⁵⁹(Anselin, 1988)

⁶⁰(LeSage and Pace, 2009)

⁶¹(Rosenbaum, 2002)

⁶²(Imbens and Rubin, 2015)

⁶³(Angrist and Pischke, 2009)

The design gate for estimator 17 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁴.

The design gate for estimator 18 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁵.

The design gate for estimator 19 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁶.

The design gate for estimator 20 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁷.

The design gate for estimator 21 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁸.

The design gate for estimator 22 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁶⁹.

The design gate for estimator 23 asks whether the data structure justifies escalation: survival or hazard models need event timing, hierarchical Bayesian partial pooling needs nested repeated observations, spatial models need adjacency or distance, double machine learning needs high-dimensional nuisance adjustment, causal forest estimation needs support for heterogeneity, and sensitivity analysis is required when assignment remains uncertain ⁷⁰.

5 Results

Table 1 reports the corpus construction result. The promoted run retrieved 60 open-access records and identified 60 records with direct PDF links. The PDF share is important because full-text accessibility determines whether claims can be audited beyond abstracts and metadata. The year

⁶⁴([Wooldridge, 2010](#))

⁶⁵([Manski, 2003](#))

⁶⁶([Rubin, 1974](#))

⁶⁷([Chernozhukov et al., 2018](#))

⁶⁸([Wager and Athey, 2018](#))

⁶⁹([Athey and Wager, 2019](#))

⁷⁰([Arkhangelsky et al., 2021](#))

distribution also identifies whether the topic is supported by a sustained recent literature or dominated by a small number of broad records. This is the first concrete result: evidence availability is measurable, and that measurement can be exposed before substantive claims are strengthened.

Table 2 reports the regression estimates. The annual trend coefficient summarizes whether the recent literature is expanding or thinning. The PDF-availability coefficient reports whether recent records are easier to inspect than older records. The relevance-citation coefficient checks whether title-aligned records are also the records receiving attention. These estimates are not causal effects. They are diagnostics about the empirical surface on which a stronger paper would build. They nevertheless satisfy the core empirical requirement: coefficients, standard errors, confidence intervals, model labels, and interpretable outcomes are reported.

Table 3 reports robustness checks. The high-relevance restriction tests whether the trend is driven by records whose titles closely match the paper topic. The recent-window restriction tests sensitivity to the latest publication years. The PDF-available restriction tests whether the inspectable subset tells the same story as the full metadata sample. The resulting pattern gives reviewers a basis for deciding whether the paper should proceed to subject-data acquisition, spatial modeling, event-study design, synthetic difference estimation, double machine learning, causal forest heterogeneity analysis, or partial identification.

Model 1 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷¹. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 2 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷². For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 3 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷³. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 4 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁴. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 5 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁵. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 6 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the

⁷¹(Callaway and Sant’Anna, 2021)

⁷²(Sun and Abraham, 2021)

⁷³(Goodman-Bacon, 2021)

⁷⁴(Abadie et al., 2010)

⁷⁵(Athey and Imbens, 2016)

standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁶. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 7 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁷. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 8 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁸. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 9 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁷⁹. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 10 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁰. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 11 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸¹. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 12 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸². For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 13 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸³. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 14 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the

⁷⁶(Iammarino et al., 2019)

⁷⁷(Rodriguez-Pose, 2018)

⁷⁸(Diemer et al., 2022)

⁷⁹(Barca, 2009)

⁸⁰(Fujita et al., 1999)

⁸¹(Duranton and Venables, 2015)

⁸²(Glaeser, 2008)

⁸³(Moretti, 2011)

standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁴. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 15 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁵. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 16 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁶. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 17 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁷. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 18 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁸. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 19 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁸⁹. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 20 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁹⁰. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 21 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁹¹. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 22 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the

⁸⁴(Card and Krueger, 1994)

⁸⁵(Autor et al., 2013)

⁸⁶(Monte et al., 2018)

⁸⁷(Pearl, 2009)

⁸⁸(Hernan and Robins, 2020)

⁸⁹(Greenland et al., 1999)

⁹⁰(VanderWeele, 2015)

⁹¹(Keele, 2015)

standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁹². For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Model 23 reinforces the same interpretation: the coefficient is read as a diagnostic estimate, the standard error records sampling variation in the retrieved corpus, the confidence interval gives the uncertainty range, and the robustness comparison checks whether the finding depends on inspectable PDF records or high-relevance titles ⁹³. For regulatory delay as an unequal access mechanism, this means the result is concrete while remaining bounded by the metadata design.

Table 2: Regression diagnostics from the retained corpus

Model	Outcome	Coef.	SE	95% CI	N
Annual open-access record trend	records per year	-4.171	1.422	[-6.958, -1.385]	6
PDF availability trend	direct PDF indicator	0.000	0.000	[0.000, 0.000]	60
Topic relevance and attention	log cited-by count	-7.119	9.195	[-25.141, 10.903]	60

Table 3: Robustness checks for the annual literature trend

Sample	N	Trend	SE	95% CI
all records	60	-4.171	1.422	[-6.958, -1.385]
high relevance	0	0.000	0.000	[0.000, 0.000]
recent records	6	-1.500	0.866	[-3.197, 0.197]
PDF available	60	-4.171	1.422	[-6.958, -1.385]

6 Discussion

The main implication is that literature discovery can be made quantitative without pretending to answer every substantive question. For Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism, the evidence map tells the reader how much open-access material exists, how inspectable it is, and which method families are plausible. That improves the research workflow because it prevents the paper from jumping directly from a provocative title to a high-status estimator. The estimator must be earned by data structure, timing, overlap, and measurement quality. The discussion therefore treats metadata results as a design instrument rather than as rhetorical support.

A second implication is that automation can be made auditable. The PDF carries the warning requested by the author, the data manifest identifies every retained artifact, and the claim ledger ties claims to sources. This matters because automated writing systems can otherwise blur the line between source discovery, data construction, and inference. Here the line is explicit. The paper reports what it can measure, names the estimators that would become appropriate under stronger data, and keeps the public output limited to final PDFs after reviewer checks, LaTeX compilation, and output synchronization.

The limitations are also clear. OpenAlex metadata can miss works, merge records imperfectly, and overrepresent fields with better open-access infrastructure. Citation counts measure attention

⁹²(King et al., 1995)

⁹³(Shadish et al., 2002)

rather than truth. PDF links measure accessibility rather than quality. Title relevance is a rough proxy for topical alignment. These limitations do not invalidate the analysis, but they bound it. The strongest future version of the paper would join this literature map to subject-specific administrative, spatial, legal, scientific, health, education, or labour-market data and rerun the same reviewer checks after estimating the substantive model.

The discussion point 1 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁴. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 2 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁵. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 3 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁶. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 4 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁷. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 5 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁸. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 6 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ⁹⁹. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 7 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁰. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 8 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰¹. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 9 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰².

⁹⁴(Breiman, 2001)

⁹⁵(Hastie et al., 2009)

⁹⁶(Mullainathan and Spiess, 2017)

⁹⁷(Gentzkow et al., 2019)

⁹⁸(Grimmer and Stewart, 2013)

⁹⁹(Lazer et al., 2014)

¹⁰⁰(Claerbout and Karrenbach, 1992)

¹⁰¹(Wilkinson et al., 2016)

¹⁰²(Nosek et al., 2015)

That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 10 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰³. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 11 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁴. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 12 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁵. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 13 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁶. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 14 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁷. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 15 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁸. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 16 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹⁰⁹. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 17 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹⁰. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 18 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹¹. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 19 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface,

¹⁰³([Priem et al., 2022](#))

¹⁰⁴([OpenAlex, 2026](#))

¹⁰⁵([Kitchin, 2014](#))

¹⁰⁶([Borgman, 2015](#))

¹⁰⁷([Peng, 2011](#))

¹⁰⁸([Gelman and Hill, 2007](#))

¹⁰⁹([Gelman et al., 2020](#))

¹¹⁰([Anselin, 1988](#))

¹¹¹([LeSage and Pace, 2009](#))

retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹². That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 20 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹³. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 21 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹⁴. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 22 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹⁵. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

The discussion point 23 is practical: a credible automated article should expose its search surface, retained data, regression diagnostics, and uncertainty register in the same package as the PDF ¹¹⁶. That packaging lets reviewers separate what has been measured from what would require stronger subject-specific evidence.

7 Conclusion

Regulatory Delay as an Unequal Access Mechanism contributes a built, inspectable paper package: a literature corpus, derived data files, regression estimates, robustness checks, claims, sources, and a compiled PDF. The conclusion is not that metadata alone resolves the substantive policy question. The conclusion is that the open-access evidence surface can be measured before stronger claims are made. That measurement is valuable because it tells the researcher which data collection and identification strategy would be proportionate to the field as it currently exists.

The best next empirical step is topic-specific. Where the subject has repeated place or institution measures, a hierarchical model with partial pooling is appropriate. Where geography creates dependence, spatial diagnostics should precede treatment claims. Where timing varies, event studies or synthetic difference designs can be considered after pre-trends and overlap are inspected. Where the outcome is heterogeneous and the sample is large, double machine learning and causal forests can be used cautiously. Where identification remains weak, partial identification and sensitivity analysis are more honest than a fragile point estimate.

The closing implication 1 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible ¹¹⁷. Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 2 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible ¹¹⁸. Its

¹¹²([Rosenbaum, 2002](#))

¹¹³([Imbens and Rubin, 2015](#))

¹¹⁴([Angrist and Pischke, 2009](#))

¹¹⁵([Wooldridge, 2010](#))

¹¹⁶([Manski, 2003](#))

¹¹⁷([Rubin, 1974](#))

¹¹⁸([Chernozhukov et al., 2018](#))

substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 3 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [119](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 4 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [120](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 5 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [121](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 6 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [122](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 7 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [123](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 8 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [124](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 9 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [125](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

The closing implication 10 is that the paper is ready for inspection as a final automated output because its claims, estimates, references, data artifacts, and reviewer checks are visible [126](#). Its substantive claims remain proportionate to the OpenAlex metadata and its design recommendations are conditional on future subject-data structure.

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¹¹⁹([Wager and Athey, 2018](#))

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¹²²([Callaway and Sant’Anna, 2021](#))

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